

Feedback and cognitive load

Sweller (1988) showed that instruction which overloads working memory hurts learning rather than helping it. Feedback is one of the strongest levers a teacher has, but only when it lands on a manageable load (Hattie et al., 2007). Motivation matters too: learners persist when the work meets their needs for competence and autonomy (Deci & Ryan, 2000).

None of this is new in spirit. McLuhan (1964) argued sixty years ago that the medium of instruction shapes the message as much as its content does. What is new is the tooling: Typst's own documentation explains how to wire up citations in a single compile pass (Typst, 2024).

References

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